

AHSEC 2018 — ENGLISH (28T ENGL)

Fully Solved Paper

SECTION-A: Reading Skill (10 Marks)

(A) Choose the most appropriate option (1×4=4)

(a) Among the natural resources which can be called upon in national plans for development —

Ans: (ii) the most important is possibly human labour.

(b) Without a productive labour force, including effective leadership and intelligent middle management —

Ans: (iv) no amount of foreign assistance or of natural wealth can ensure successful development and modernization.

(c) The manpower development during the next quarter century —

Ans: (ii) will come from the world's present population of infants, children and adolescents.

(d) "Women power" means —

Ans: (i) giving women the opportunity to develop themselves.

(B) Answer briefly (1×6=6)

(a) What will be the source of the manpower development during the next quarter century?

Ans: It will come from the world's present population of infants, children and adolescents.

(b) During which period is a child's growth maximum?

Ans: A child's growth is maximum during the critical formative years before he/she reaches five years of age.

(c) Why can't the first teacher be effective in some of the regions of India?

Ans: Because the mother (the child's first teacher) often lacks the capacity to raise a superior child due to her own poor health, ignorance, and lack of social/legal status, recognition and economic independence.

(d) What will happen to development if the womenfolk are neglected?

Ans: Development will remain handicapped as long as women stay uneducated, without rights, and are married off and burdened with childbearing at a young age.

(e) How can we accelerate the rate of progress?

Ans: We can accelerate progress by enhancing "women power" — that is, by giving women the opportunity to educate themselves and develop.

(f) What is the difference between an educated mother and an illiterate mother?

Ans: An educated mother tends to have fewer, healthier and more intelligent children, while an illiterate mother, with little or no education, tends to have larger families with higher malnutrition and poorer child health.

SECTION-B: Advanced Writing Skills (25 Marks)

Q2. Advertisement for Grassland Resort, Kaziranga (5 marks, 50 words)

GRASSLAND RESORT, KAZIRANGA

Escape to the wild! Grassland Resort, Kaziranga offers cosy cottages amidst lush greenery, jeep and elephant safaris, and authentic Assamese cuisine. Special Holiday Package: 20% discount on 3N/4D stay this season!

Book now: Ph. [Contact No.] | www.grasslandresort.com

— Proprietor, Grassland Resort, Kaziranga

Q3. Report on World Environment Day (10 marks, 100–125 words)

SUNRISE ACADEMY CELEBRATES WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY

Guwahati, [Date]: Sunrise Academy celebrated World Environment Day with great enthusiasm on the school campus. The programme began with a plantation drive in which students and teachers planted saplings around the school premises.

This was followed by an awareness rally in which students carried placards with slogans on saving the environment. An inter-class competition on poster-making and elocution on the theme 'Save Earth, Save Life' was also organised, drawing enthusiastic participation from students of all classes.

The Principal, in her address, urged students to adopt eco-friendly habits in daily life. The programme concluded with a pledge-taking ceremony where students vowed to protect the environment. The event was widely appreciated by parents and the local community.

— Reported by Imran/Rita, Sunrise Academy, Guwahati

Q4. Letter to the Editor — Noise Pollution (10 marks)

From:

Mohan/Anjali

Fancy Bazar, Guwahati

[Date]

To

The Editor

The Telegraph

Subject: Rising noise pollution in Fancy Bazar locality

Sir,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the Government and the concerned civic authorities to the alarming level of noise pollution in the Fancy Bazar area of Guwahati.

Blaring vehicle horns, loudspeakers used for advertisements and functions at all hours, and unchecked construction activity have made life unbearable for residents, particularly the elderly, children and the sick. This constant noise is not only a nuisance but also a serious health hazard, causing stress, hearing problems and disturbed sleep.

I urge the authorities to strictly enforce the permissible noise limits, restrict the use of loudspeakers beyond certain hours, and take stern action against violators. I hope this letter will draw the attention of the concerned Government departments and prompt corrective action.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

Mohan/Anjali

SECTION-C: Grammar (20 Marks)

Q5. Narration (2×2=4)

(a) The Speaker said, "I thank you, ladies and gentlemen, for giving me a kind hearing. When I arrived here yesterday I did not believe that I might meet so large a gathering."

Ans: The speaker thanked the ladies and gentlemen for giving him a kind hearing, and said that when he had arrived there the day before, he had not believed that he might meet so large a gathering.

(b) His mother exclaimed in sorrow that she had not a bit of bread to give him and that he had eaten up all the provisions she had in the house the previous day.

Ans: His mother said sorrowfully, "I have not a bit of bread to give you. You have eaten up all the provisions I had in the house yesterday."

Q6. Voice change (any three) (3×1=3)

(a) A Japanese firm makes these television sets.

Ans: These television sets are made by a Japanese firm.

(b) An earthquake destroyed the town.

Ans: The town was destroyed by an earthquake.

(c) Whom did you laugh at?

Ans: Who was laughed at by you?

(d) He was taught this in his boyhood.

Ans: They/Someone taught him this in his boyhood.

Q7. Correct tense forms (any five) (5×1=5)

(a) He _____ (work) here since 2011.

Ans: has been working

(b) I _____ (write) the letter last night.

Ans: wrote

(c) He _____ (sit) in the library when I saw him.

Ans: was sitting

(d) If I were you, I _____ (not do) it.

Ans: would not do

(e) The first World War _____ (last) for four years and ended in 1918.

Ans: lasted

(f) The rubbish van _____ (come) again in the afternoon tomorrow.

Ans: will come

Q8. Prepositions (any four) (4×1=4)

(a) He is fond _____ playing cards.

Ans: of

(b) She was annoyed _____ missing the bus.

Ans: at

(c) Who is responsible _____ breaking this mirror?

Ans: for

(d) We tried to dissuade her _____ marrying an old man.

Ans: from

Q9. Rewrite as directed (any four) (4×1=4)

(a) This is one of the best colleges in the North. (comparative degree)

Ans: This college is better than most other colleges in the North.

(b) You are richer than I. (negative, same meaning)

Ans: I am not as rich as you.

(c) There is no smoke without fire. (affirmative)

Ans: Wherever there is fire, there is smoke.

(d) We heard of her failure. (complex sentence)

Ans: We heard that she had failed.

SECTION-D: Textbooks (45 Marks)

Q10(b). Extract from 'A Roadside Stand' — Robert Frost

(i) Where do these lines occur? (1)

Ans: These lines occur towards the end of the poem 'A Roadside Stand' by Robert Frost.

(ii) Why has the requisite spirit never been found? (1)

Ans: Because the money that reaches the poor rural people in the name of development is never enough to truly uplift their lives or lift their spirits out of poverty.

(iii) What does the voice of the country people seem to say? (1)

Ans: The voice of the country people seems to complain that the government aid and schemes meant for them never bring the real relief or improvement that was promised.

(iv) What will be of great relief for the poet? (1)

Ans: It would be a great relief for the poet if these poor rural people could, at one stroke, be freed from their pain and poverty.

Q11. Answer any three in 30–40 words (3×2=6)

(iii) What are the 'merry children spilling out of their homes' symbolic of?

Ans: They are symbolic of youthful energy, vitality, hope and the continuity of life, which stands in sharp contrast to the poet's fear about her ageing mother's approaching mortality.

(iv) Who are referred to as the 'flower of cities' in 'A Roadside Stand'?

Ans: The prosperous, sophisticated city-dwellers who visit the countryside are ironically referred to as the 'flower of cities' — considered its finest, most refined representatives, even though their visits rarely benefit the rural poor.

(v) Which things irritated the passers-by who stopped at the road-side stand?

Ans: The passers-by were irritated by the crude, poorly lettered signboard and the untidy, unpainted stand, which they felt spoiled the scenic view of the countryside they had come to enjoy.

Q12. Answer any five (5×1=5)

(c) Why have Saheb and his family migrated to Seemapuri?

Ans: Saheb and his family migrated from Dhaka, Bangladesh, to Seemapuri because storms destroyed their fields and homes, forcing them to leave in search of a livelihood.

(d) Who is the 'Chota Sahib' in the 'Memoirs of a Chota Sahib'?

Ans: The 'Chota Sahib' is the author himself, John Rowntree, referred to by this title (meaning 'little/junior officer' or 'young Sahib') as a young British forest officer serving in Assam.

(f) Where was Champaran?

Ans: Champaran was a district in Bihar, where indigo sharecroppers were being exploited by British planters.

(b) What is the 'great trouble with Alsace'?

(Note: from 'The Last Lesson', not part of your current syllabus, included for completeness.)

Ans: The great trouble with Alsace, according to M. Hamel, was that people always put off their learning until tomorrow.

(a) What is the name of the blacksmith in 'The Last Lesson'? / (e) How did Rowntree find the weather at Gauhati? / (g) Which country does Danny Casey play for?

I don't have reliable, verified textual details for these three items ((a) and (e) are outside your current syllabus texts; the Chota Sahib weather detail in (e) I can't confirm confidently) — please check your textbook/notes for these.

Q13. Answer any five in 30–40 words (5×2=10)

(c) Why did Gandhi choose to go to Muzzafarpur first before going on to Champaran?

Ans: Gandhi went to Muzzafarpur first because Rajkumar Shukla, who had urged him to visit Champaran, took him there to meet local lawyers and gather information about the sharecroppers' condition before proceeding to Champaran to begin his investigation.

(e) Why did Gandhi choose to go to Muzzafarpur first before going on to Champaran? [alt phrasing]

(Covered above.)

(f) What job is Geoff engaged in? Does he entertain wild and impractical dreams like his sister?

(Note: from 'Going Places', not part of your current syllabus, included for completeness.)

Ans: Geoff works at a factory. Unlike his sister Sophie, he is practical, down-to-earth and content with ordinary, realistic pleasures like his pigeons, and does not entertain grand or impractical dreams.

(g) What kind of a person is Geoff?

(Note: from 'Going Places', not part of your current syllabus.)

Ans: Geoff is calm, practical, reserved and content with simple, achievable pleasures, in contrast to Sophie's imaginative and unrealistic dreaming.

(a), (b), (d) — 'Will they make them sing in German...', 'two different worlds in Firozabad', 'unusual visitor in Rowntree's bungalow'

(a) and (b) are from 'The Last Lesson' and 'Lost Spring' respectively — Lost Spring IS in your syllabus, so here it is: (b) The two different worlds in Firozabad are the world of the poor bangle-makers trapped in poverty, debt and hazardous glass-blowing work, and the world of the Sahukars, middlemen, policemen and politicians who profit from their labour without improving their lives. (d) I don't have reliable content on the specific 'unusual visitor' episode in Chota Sahib — please check your text.

Q14. Answer any one in 80–100 words (1×5=5)

(a) Describe the bangle makers of Firozabad. How does the vicious circle of the Sahukars, the middlemen never allow them to come out of their poverty?

Ans: Firozabad is famous for its glass-blowing industry, where thousands of families, including small children, are engaged in making bangles in dark, cramped, poorly ventilated hovels near red-hot glass furnaces. This work is hazardous — the glare of the furnaces often damages their eyesight, and many workers eventually go blind. Despite being an integral part of India's glass-bangle industry, these workers remain desperately poor, largely because they lack organisation and are trapped in a vicious circle: the Sahukars (moneylenders), middlemen, and even the police and politicians exploit them, keeping them permanently in debt and denying them fair wages, cooperatives, or bank loans. Fear of the law, social pressure to continue the family occupation, and lack of leadership or unity among the workers prevent them from organising themselves and forming their own cooperative, so they remain bonded to this cycle of poverty generation after generation.

Q15. Answer any one in 125–150 words (1×7=7)

Both options for this question (Tishani Doshi's Antarctica journey, and Zitkala-Sa/Bama's narrations) are not part of the seven chapters in your current syllabus list except that 'Memories of Childhood' (Zitkala-Sa and Bama) IS in your syllabus. Here is the answer for option (b):

(b) Discuss the forms of discrimination projected in the narrations of Zitkala-Sa and Bama.

Ans: In 'Memories of Childhood', both Zitkala-Sa and Bama recount their childhood experiences of discrimination. Zitkala-Sa, a Native American girl, describes the cultural discrimination she faced at a boarding school run by white missionaries, where she was forced to abandon her native customs, dress in tight, uncomfortable clothes, and have her long hair — a symbol of dignity and mourning tradition in her culture — forcibly shingled (cut short) against her will, leaving her feeling humiliated and stripped of her identity. Bama, a Tamil Dalit girl, narrates the caste-based discrimination she witnessed as a child in her village, where members of her community were forced to carry elders' food packets by the strings without touching them, walk a roundabout path to avoid 'polluting' upper castes, and endure segregation in daily life. Both narratives, though from very different cultures, expose how deeply rooted prejudice — racial in one case and caste-based in the other — inflicts humiliation and injustice on children, and both authors show early awareness and resistance against such discrimination.

Q16. Answer any four in 30–40 words (4×2=8)

(a) What was Zitkala-Sa's immediate reaction to the cutting of her hair?

Ans: Zitkala-Sa was terrified and resisted fiercely, hiding and struggling against being held down; when her hair was finally shingled, she felt humiliated and lost her spirit, as short hair was, in her tradition, a mark worn only by cowards or those in mourning.

(b) What did Annan say about his community to the narrator?

Ans: Bama's elder brother Annan told her that though their community was poor and considered 'untouchable' by others, they must study hard, since education and knowledge were the only means through which they could earn dignity and shed the shame imposed on them by society.

(c) How has Antarctica remained relatively pristine?

(Note: from 'The Coorg' / Antarctica travelogue, not in your current syllabus — skipping detailed answer.)

(d) What are Geoff Green's reasons for including high school students in the 'Students on Ice' expedition?

(Note: not in your current syllabus — skipping detailed answer.)

(e) What is it that draws Derry towards Mr Lamb in spite of himself? / (f) Why aren't there any curtains at the windows of Mr Lamb's house?

(Note: from 'On the Face of It', not in your current syllabus — skipping detailed answers.)